

PERFORMANCE IMPROVEMENT PLAN (PIP)



NAME **JOE THEUERKAUF**
POSITION **Full Stack Developer**

DATE 09/09/2026
DEPT IT Development

On September 04, 2026, you met with your manager to discuss concerns regarding your work performance. During that conversation, you were informed that the amount of completed work during your employment with CME Corp. has been below the level expected for your position and that immediate, measurable, and sustained improvement is required.

This Performance Improvement Plan is intended to clearly document the areas requiring improvement, establish measurable expectations, and provide a structured opportunity for you to demonstrate that you can consistently complete assigned work within reasonable timeframes.

This plan follows the general structure of CME's existing Performance Improvement Plan format.

ISSUES AND CONCERNS:

Productivity and Timely Completion of Work

The primary concern is that assigned development work has not consistently been completed within a timeframe appropriate for the scope and complexity of the assignment.

Specific concerns include:

- Assigned work remaining in progress for extended periods without reaching a complete, testable, and usable state.
- Significant amounts of time being recorded against assignments without a corresponding level of completed work.
- Difficulty maintaining focus on assigned priorities and carrying them through to completion.
- Work requiring additional follow-up, intervention, or reassignment before it can be completed.
- Extended work hours that have not resulted in a sustainable level of completed work.

Productivity will be measured primarily by the timely completion of assigned deliverables. Hours recorded, time spent, or the number of commits made will not independently demonstrate satisfactory performance.

Focus and Work Prioritization

Concerns have also been identified regarding the ability to remain focused on the work currently assigned.

Assignments must be completed according to the priority established by your manager. Moving between tasks, expanding the scope of an assignment, or beginning unrelated work can delay completion and make it difficult to determine actual progress.

You are expected to remain focused on the current priority until it is completed, blocked, or your manager changes the assignment.

Work Hours and Time Reporting

Human Resources has raised concerns regarding your reported hours and multiple instances in which Time Doctor activity was identified as unusual.

PERFORMANCE IMPROVEMENT PLAN (PIP)



These concerns include whether recorded time consistently represents active, work-related activity and whether the amount of time reported is reasonably supported by the work completed during that period.

Accurate reporting time is required. Extended hours, unusual work patterns, inactive periods, and schedule variations must be consistent with assigned CME responsibilities and must be explainable when reviewed.

IMPROVEMENT REQUIRED:

1. Timely Completion of Assigned Work

You must:

- Complete assigned work within the timeframe established with your manager.
- Carry assignments through implementation, testing, review, and completion.
- Produce complete and usable deliverables rather than leaving work partially implemented for extended periods.
- Demonstrate measurable progress throughout each workday and workweek.
- Notify your manager as soon as an assignment is at risk of missing its expected completion date.
- Provide a specific explanation and recovery plan when an expected completion date cannot be met.

The expected completion timeframe will account for the scope, complexity, dependencies, and technical risks associated with each assignment.

2. Productivity

You must:

- Demonstrate a consistent and sustainable level of completed work appropriate for your position.
- Complete the weekly deliverables agreed upon with your manager unless a documented blocker, approved scope change, or priority change prevents completion.
- Ensure that recorded work time results in meaningful progress toward completion.
- Reduce the amount of time that assignments remain open without a completed result.
- Avoid spending extended periods on investigation, redesign, or secondary concerns that do not materially move the assigned work toward completion.
- Ask for assistance promptly when continued independent work is not producing progress.

Performance will be evaluated based on completed deliverables, quality, complexity, and timeliness.

Commit counts and hours recorded will be considered supporting information but will not be the primary measurement of productivity.

3. Focus and Prioritization

You must:

- Work according to the priorities established by your manager.
- Maintain focus on the current assignment until it is completed, blocked, or reprioritized.
- Avoid beginning additional or unrelated work without approval.
- Avoid unnecessarily expanding the scope of assigned work.
- Break larger assignments into clear, reviewable milestones with expected completion dates.
- Obtain approval before changing the planned approach when the change would materially affect scope or completion time.

4. Communication of Progress and Blockers

You must:

PERFORMANCE IMPROVEMENT PLAN (PIP)



- Provide a brief written update at the end of each workday during the PIP.
- Identify what was completed, what remains, and the next action required.
- Communicate blockers when they occur rather than waiting until an expected completion date has passed.
- Clearly identify any dependency, access issue, technical issue, or change in scope affecting completion.
- Raise concerns early enough for your manager to provide assistance or adjust the assignment.
- Attend scheduled progress meetings prepared to demonstrate completed work.

A blocker must be specific and documented. General difficulty with an assignment, continued investigation, or uncertainty without requesting assistance will not automatically justify a missed completion date.

5. Work Hours and Time Reporting

You must:

- Accurately record only time spent performing CME-related work.
- Maintain Time Doctor activity that reasonably corresponds with active work during recorded periods.
- Promptly explain unusual activity patterns or extended inactive periods when requested.
- Notify your manager of schedule changes, absences, or interruptions as soon as reasonably possible.
- Obtain approval before regularly working extended hours or overtime.
- Maintain a sustainable work schedule rather than relying on extended hours to compensate for incomplete assignments.

Working additional hours does not replace the requirement to complete assigned work efficiently and within an appropriate timeframe.

I, Sean McCarthy, will be monitoring and reviewing your progress on each of the above items requiring improvement. We trust that in so doing, we can guide you in becoming a contributing employee at CME Corp.

Effective September 14, 2026, you are placed on a 30 -day PIP. During this time, you will be expected to improve and maintain progress on the plan outlined in this PIP. If any portion of this improvement plan is violated at any time during the specified timeframe, disciplinary action to include separation from the company may occur prior to 30 days. A decrease in performance after successfully completing the improvement plan may result in being dismissed from CME Corp. without the issuance of another warning or improvement plan.

The PIP does not alter the employment-at-will relationship. Additionally, the contents of this PIP are to remain confidential. Should you have questions or concerns regarding the content, you will be expected to follow up directly with your supervisor.

As always, the Open-Door Policy is available for you to discuss any concerns.

Your signature acknowledges this discussion. It does not indicate agreement or disagreement with this performance improvement plan.

PERFORMANCE IMPROVEMENT PLAN (PIP)



Structured Work Assignments and Support

During the PIP period, work will be organized into multiple defined features, with each feature divided into specific, preassigned tickets. Each ticket will include an expected outcome, acceptance criteria, priority, and target completion date so that progress and completion can be measured consistently.

To support successful completion of this work:

- Tickets will be assigned in advance and grouped by feature.
- Each feature will have clearly defined functional requirements and completion expectations, with the exception of the Alerting tasks where a part of the work will be to outline the tickets and strategy to complete the feature.
- Subject matter experts will be identified and made available to answer business processes, data, or technical questions.
- Larger tickets may be divided into smaller milestones when necessary to provide clear evidence of progress.
- Completed work must include implementation, appropriate testing, documentation where required, and readiness for deployment or use.
- Progress will be reviewed based on the completion of assigned tickets and features, not solely on time recorded or development activity.

The assigned features are also expected to contribute to the continued advancement of CME's general web application. While completing the assigned work, you are expected to make reasonable improvements to shared application components, code quality, testing, maintainability, and user experience when those improvements directly support the assigned feature.

General application improvements must remain appropriately scoped and must not delay completion of the assigned tickets. Any broader refactoring, architectural change, or additional work that could materially affect the expected completion date must be discussed with and approved by your manager before proceeding.

The successful completion of this portion of the plan will be measured by:

1. Timely completion of the preassigned tickets.
2. Completion of the broader features supported by those tickets.
3. Prompt use of the assigned subject matter experts when clarification or assistance is required.
4. Delivery of work that meets the documented requirements and acceptance criteria.
5. Demonstrated advancement of the general web application without unnecessary expansion of scope or delay to assigned deliverables.

Assigned Deliverables and Weekly Milestones

The Performance Improvement Plan will begin on **September 14, 2026**.

The Build Central assignment identified below as Week 0 is work currently assigned prior to the start of the PIP and is expected to be completed before the PIP begins. Beginning September 14, specific weekly development assignments will be used as measurable checkpoints throughout the Performance Improvement Plan.

PERFORMANCE IMPROVEMENT PLAN (PIP)



Each weekly assignment is expected to be completed by the Friday identified below unless a documented blocker, manager-approved scope change, dependency outside of the employee's control, or change in priority affects the completion date.

For purposes of this plan, an assignment will be considered complete when the required implementation, appropriate testing, and required documentation have been completed and the work is in a testable and reviewable state. Delays caused solely by required code review, deployment scheduling, or another dependency outside of the employee's control will not by themselves constitute a missed deadline provided that the employee's assigned work was completed on time and the dependency was communicated promptly.

Any blocker or issue that places a weekly deliverable at risk must be communicated as soon as it becomes known. A missed deadline should not be the first notification that an assignment encountered difficulty.

Week 0 - Current Build Central Assignment

Due: Friday, September 11, 2026

Prior to the start of the PIP

Complete the currently assigned Build Central work.

The completed feature must provide a method to export the list of Build Central projects meeting the specified criteria and include the required data points identified in the spreadsheet provided by Ryan.

Completion includes:

- Applying the documented criteria for determining which Build Central projects are included.
- Providing an export of the qualifying projects.
- Including the required data fields identified in Ryan's spreadsheet.
- Verifying the exported information against the underlying Build Central data.
- Completing appropriate testing of the filtering and export functionality.
- Delivering the work in a complete, usable, and reviewable state.

Week 1 - DTS Over \$20K Alert Migration

Due: Friday, September 18, 2026

Refactor `allrivers/periodicJobs/dtsOver20KAlert.php` into NewRivers using the NewRivers database synchronization tables.

The implementation must establish the initial generic alert email functionality that will be used as the foundation for the reusable alert framework developed during the following weeks.

Completion includes:

- Recreating the DTS Over \$20K alert functionality in NewRivers.
- Using NewRivers synchronized database tables as the data source.
- Creating a generic Mailable capable of being populated for alert emails.
- Ensuring the persisted email Mailable is the generic alert Mailable.
- Setting the email type to `alert.dtsover20k`.
- Preserving the required writes to `allrivers.alertTracking`.
- Preserving the required writes to `allrivers.dimReporting`.
- Adding appropriate automated testing.
- Demonstrating that the NewRivers implementation produces the expected alert results.

Week 2 - Alert Service Foundation

Due: Friday, September 25, 2026

Abstract the Week 1 alert implementation into a reusable alert service that can support the migration of additional legacy alerts into NewRivers.

PERFORMANCE IMPROVEMENT PLAN (PIP)



This assignment will implement the foundational portions of NewRivers work item 664, including the common services and application tables required to define alerts, execute them, and track their usage and results.

The implementation should establish reusable handling for:

- Alert definitions and configuration.
- Alert execution.
- Alert run history.
- Recipient resolution.
- Email persistence and delivery through the generic alert Mailable.
- Legacy alert tracking.
- Error and partial-run handling.
- Duplicate prevention and idempotency where required.

The design must support subsequent legacy alert migrations without requiring each alert to independently recreate scheduling, recipient resolution, email persistence, execution history, and legacy tracking logic.

Week 3 - Complete Alert Framework / Work Item 664

Due: Friday, October 2, 2026

Complete NewRivers work item 664, including the remaining implementation and associated automated testing.

Completion includes the full reusable alert framework documented in the work item, including:

- alerts and alert_runs persistence.
- Alert registry and runner.
- Role-based recipient resolution.
- Alert run recording.
- Legacy alert tracking integration.
- Generic alert Mailable.
- Alert jobs and command execution.
- Source and enrichment handling.
- Duplicate prevention.
- Empty-result handling.
- Failure and partial-run behavior.
- Email intent creation and delivery-status integration.
- Required automated testing defined by the work item.

The completed framework must be in a testable and reviewable state and satisfy the documented requirements and acceptance criteria of work item 664.

Once this milestone has been completed, work may resume on the previously assigned dynamic menuing feature.

Week 4 - Dynamic Menuing

Due: Friday, October 9, 2026

Complete the previously assigned dynamic menuing work according to its documented requirements and acceptance criteria.

Completion includes:

- Completion of the remaining implementation.
- Appropriate automated testing.
- Resolution of known issues within the documented scope.
- Verification of expected menu behavior and access rules.

PERFORMANCE IMPROVEMENT PLAN (PIP)



- Delivery of the feature in a complete, testable, and reviewable state.

The scope of the assignment should not be expanded in a way that places the October 9 completion date at risk without prior discussion and approval from the manager.

Weekly Evaluation

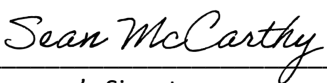
The weekly assignments above are intended to provide objective and measurable checkpoints throughout the Performance Improvement Plan.

Performance will be evaluated based on:

1. Completion of each assigned weekly deliverable by its established Friday deadline.
2. Whether the completed work satisfies the documented requirements and acceptance criteria.
3. Delivery of complete and usable work, including appropriate testing, rather than partially implemented work.
4. Consistent measurable progress toward the current week's deliverable.
5. Prompt communication of blockers, dependencies, or risks that could affect the completion date.
6. Timely requests for assistance when continued independent work is not producing meaningful progress.
7. Maintaining focus on the assigned weekly priority without unnecessary expansion of scope or movement to unrelated work.
8. Demonstrating a consistent and sustainable level of productivity appropriate for the Full Stack Developer position.

The purpose of the weekly milestones is not solely to determine whether work was completed on a particular date, but to evaluate whether the employee demonstrates sustained improvement in productivity, prioritization, communication, and timely completion throughout the PIP period.

	2026-09-10
Employee's Signature	Date

	2026-09-10
Manager's Signature	Date

PERFORMANCE IMPROVEMENT PLAN (PIP)



PROGRESS UPDATES:

Your manager will be monitoring your performance and you are expected to meet with them to review your progress. They will plan with you accordingly.

Date	Comment	Manager	Employee

Conclusion:

_____ Employee has achieved required improvements as described above.

_____ Employee has not achieved required improvements as described above.

Supervisor: _____ Date: _____

Employee: _____ Date: _____

Additional Comments: